

Jonathan Andrew Pedroza PhD

[GitHub](#) | [Website](#) | **Contact:** jpedroza1228@berkeley.edu | Berkeley, CA

Education

Doctor of Philosophy, Prevention Science (2021)

University of Oregon

Specialization: Educational Data Science

Committee: Elizabeth L Budd PhD, MPH (Chair), Atika Khurana PhD, Nichole R Kelly PhD, & Raoul S Liévanos PhD

Dissertation Title: Greater Access to Recreational Resources is Associated with More Leisure-Time Physical Activity Engagement in Counties Across the United States

Master of Science, Prevention Science (2020)

University of Oregon

Advisor: Elizabeth L Budd PhD, MPH

Master of Arts, Health Psychology (2017)

California State University, Dominguez Hills

Committee: Larry Rosen PhD (Co-Chair), L Mark Carrier PhD (Co-Chair), & Silvia Santos PhD

Thesis Title: Technology's Impact on Psychological Well-Being Independent of Negative Health Impacts in College Students

Bachelor of Arts in Psychology (2014)

California State Polytechnic University, Pomona

Publications

Pedroza, J. A., Guardado-García, J. J., Williams, M. J., Alcala, M., Nakamura, N. N., Serpas, D. G., Harrison, A., Chon, D. (2026). Measurement Invariance of the LGBT Microaggressions Scale among Latina/o/x persons and non-Latina/o/x People of Color. *LGBT Health*.

Pedroza, J. A., Serpas, D. G., Guardado-García, J. J., Zelaya, D. G., Alcala, M. S., & Keys, K. (2026). Cardiovascular Disease Risk Factors, Intersectional Minority Stressors, and Self-Reported Cardiovascular Disease Among Sexual and Gender Minority People of Color: An Exploratory Latent Class Analysis. *LGBT Health*.

Nichols, L. M., Fleming, C. M., **Pedroza, J. A.**, O'Brien, K. M., & Tanner-Smith, E. E. (2024). Psychometric Properties of the Alabama Parenting Questionnaire Among Adolescents with Substance Use Disorder Histories. *Child and Adolescent Social Work Journal*, 1-14.

Nichols, L. M., **Pedroza, J. A.**, Fleming, C. M., O'Brien, K. M., & Tanner-Smith, E. E. (2021). Social-ecological Predictors of Opioid Use among Adolescents with Histories of Substance Use Disorders. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 12.

Rosen, L. D., Carrier, L. M., **Pedroza, J. A.**, Elias, S., O'Brien, K. M., Lozano, J., ... & Ruiz, A. (2018). The Role of Executive Functioning and Technological Anxiety (FOMO) in College Course Performance as Mediated by Technology Usage and Multitasking Habits. *Psicologia Educativa*, 24(1), 14-25.

Research Experience

Addressing Inequities in the Association Between Access to Recreational Resources and Leisure-time Physical Activity in the United States. Examining Violent Crime Rates as a Moderator (2020-2021)

Supervisor: Elizabeth L Budd PhD, MPH

- Conducted literature review
- Collected and joined county-level data from various public data sources
- Conducted spatial regression techniques

Examining Physical Activity as a Mediator between Neighborhood Walkability and Obesity in a Sample of Latinx Adults (2018-2021)

Supervisors: Tasia M Smith PhD & Elizabeth L Budd PhD, MPH

- Conducted literature review
- Formulated study design
- Conducted structural equation modeling techniques
- Wrote and edited a draft of the manuscript

Investigating Psychometric Measures and Ecological Predictors for At-Risk Adolescents (2018-2020)

Supervisors: Emily E Tanner-Smith, PhD

- Conducted literature reviews
- Formulated study design
- Conducted exploratory factor analyses, multiple imputation, and regression analyses
- Wrote sections of the manuscript

Association of Depressive Symptoms and Body Mass Among Young Adults with Higher Education (2017-2021)

Supervisors: Tasia M Smith PhD, Nichole R Kelly PhD, & Elizabeth L Budd PhD, MPH

- Conducted literature review
- Conducted regression analyses
- Wrote and edited sections of the manuscript

Are Smartphones Really Mobile Devices? The Examination of Smartphone Use as a Moderator of the Relationship Between Acculturation and Screen-based Sedentary Behaviors in a Diverse Sample of Latinx Adults (2017-2019)

Supervisors: Tasia M Smith PhD, Nichole R Kelly PhD, & Elizabeth L Budd PhD, MPH

- Conducted literature review
- Conducted regression analyses
- Wrote a draft of the manuscript

Understanding Food Access in Oakridge and other Rural Communities (2017-2019)

Supervisors: Tasia M Smith PhD, Nichole R Kelly PhD, & Elizabeth L Budd PhD, MPH

- Recruited participants
- Led data collection
- Conducted focus groups
- Created relationships with rural communities
- Conducted regression analyses
- Mentored undergraduate lab members

Pokémon GO and Meet Others: Technology's Effect on Physical Activity and Social Connectedness (2016-2017)

Supervisor: Larry Rosen PhD

- Conducted literature review
- Recruited participants through social media outlets
- Conducted analyses

Differences in Prefrontal Cortex Activation and Executive Functioning Between Light and Heavy Technology Users (2015 – 2017)

Supervisors: Larry Rosen PhD, L Mark Carrier PhD, & Alex Lim MA

- Cleaned neuroimaging data using fNIR Soft
- Analyzed neuroimaging data
- Trained new lab technicians in neuroimaging measures
- Trained new lab technicians in physiological measures
- Created protocols for experiments

How Executive Functioning, Anxiety and Technology Use Impact College Students' Course Performance (2015-2016)

Supervisor: Larry Rosen PhD

- Assisted in the data collection procedures
- Addressed issues with the data collecting app
- Assisted in conducting analyses
- Mentored undergraduates

Brain Imaging Study of Adult Latinas/os Who Translate (2015 – 2017)

Supervisors: Alejandro Morales PhD & Alex Lim MA

- Conducted literature review
- Cleaned neuroimaging data using fNIR Soft
- Analyzed neuroimaging data

Content Analysis of Type 2 Diabetes Interventions for Latinos (2014)

Supervisor: Alejandro Morales PhD

- Coded articles to examine differences in interventions
- Examined practicality and possible implementation of interventions
- Examined theory involved in interventions

Presentations

National Conferences

Pedroza, J. A. (September 2020). *Examining the Longitudinal Association Between Access to Recreational Resources and Leisure-time Physical Activity Across California*. Virtual presentation at the American Public Health Association Physical Activity Twitter Conference. (<https://twitter.com/PaSectionAPHA/status/1309192269447143425>).

Nichols, L. M., Fleming, C. M., **Pedroza, J. A.**, O'Brien, K. M., & Tanner-Smith, E. E. (August 2020). *Psychometric Properties of the Alabama Parenting Questionnaire Among Adolescents in Recovery from Substance Use*. Poster presented at the American Psychological Association Convention. (Virtual Conference).

Nichols, L. M., Fleming, C. M., **Pedroza, J. A.**, O'Brien, K. M., & Tanner-Smith, E. E. (April, 2020). *Psychometric Properties of the Alabama Parenting Questionnaire Among High-risk Adolescents*. Poster to be presented at the Collaborative Perspectives on Addiction Conference, San Diego, CA. (Poster accepted but conference canceled).

Luther, G., **Pedroza, J. A.**, & Kelly, N. R. (November 2019). *The Role of Perceived Racial Discrimination and Weight Status on Depression Among Latina Women*. Poster presented at The Obesity Society, Las Vegas, NV.

Pedroza, J. A., Kelly, N. R., & Budd, E. L. (November 2019). *Neighborhood Walkability is Associated with Physical Activity in Latinx Adults, Particularly Those with High Acculturation*. Oral presentation accepted at the American Public Health Association Conference, Philadelphia, PA.

- Cahn, A. F., **Pedroza, J. A.**, Terral, H. & Budd, E. L. (November 2019). *Neighborhood Walkability, Physical Activity, and Sedentary Behaviors Examined by Perceived Health Status among Diverse Latinx Adults*. Oral presentation presented at the American Public Health Association, Philadelphia, PA.
- Folger, A. C., **Pedroza, J. A.**, Smith, T. M., Budd, E. L., & Kelly, N. R. (May 2019). *The Impact of Individual-Level Motivators of and Barriers to Healthy Food Choices on Perceived Healthy Food Access in a Rural Community*. Poster accepted for presentation at Society of Prevention Research Conference, San Francisco, California.
- Pedroza, J. A.**, Luther, G. M., Folger, A. C., Smith, T. M., Kelly, N. R., & Budd, E. L. (May 2019). *Smartphone Use as a Moderator of Bicultural Dimensions of Acculturation and Sedentary Behaviors Among a Sample of Latinx Young Adults*. Poster accepted for presentation at Society of Prevention Research Conference, San Francisco, California.
- Pedroza, J. A.**, Folger, A. C., Luther, G. M., & Smith, T. M., Kelly, N. R., & Budd, E. L. (May 2019). *Assessing Nutrition Knowledge in Rural Communities: Examining the Association between Sociodemographic Factors and Nutrition Knowledge*. Poster accepted for presentation at Society of Prevention Research Conference, San Francisco, California.
- Folger, A. C., **Pedroza, J. A.**, Smith, T. M., Budd, E. L., & Kelly, N. R. (August 2019). *Depression and Chronic Health Conditions: Examining Racial Identity as a Moderator*. Poster accepted for presentation at American Psychological Association Convention, Chicago, Illinois.
- Smith, T. M., **Pedroza, J. A.**, Kashani, Y., Kelly, N. R., Budd, E. L., & Giuliani, N. R. (January 2019). *Depressive Symptoms are Associated with Body Mass Index among Young Adults with Higher Education*. Poster to be presented at National Multicultural Conference and Summit, Denver, Colorado.
- Pedroza, J. A.**, Smith, T. M., & Budd, E. L. (July 2018). *Language Competence and Screen-time Sedentary Behaviors are Moderated by Smartphones*. Poster presentation at APA Division 45 Research Conference, Austin, Texas.

Regional Conferences

- Pedroza, J. A.**, Kelly N. R., & Budd, E. L. (October 2019). *The Association of Neighborhood Walkability and Physical Activity in Differing Levels of Acculturated Latinx Adults*. Oral presentation accepted at the Oregon Public Health Association Conference, Corvallis, OR.
- Lieberman, N., **Pedroza, J. A.**, Elias, S., Jimenez, M., Cheever, N. A., Carrier, L.M., & Rosen, L. D. (April 2017). *The Psychology of New Technologies: Exploring Executive Functioning, Anxiety, Physical Activity, and Time Perception*. Symposium presented at Western Psychological Association Convention, Sacramento, California.
- Lim, A. F., **Pedroza, J. A.**, O'Brien, K., Ceja, L., Jimenez, M., Carrier, L.M., & Rosen, L. D. (April 2016). *Using Functional Near-Infrared Spectroscopy to Examine the Impact of Personal Technology Usage on Executive Functioning*. Symposium presented at Western Psychological Association Convention, Long Beach, California.
- Lim, A. F., **Pedroza, J. A.**, Jimenez, M., Morales, A., Carrier, L.M., & Rosen, L. D. (April 2016). *New Developments in Language Brokering Research Among Latinas/os*. Symposium presented at Western Psychological Association Convention, Long Beach, California.
- Pedroza, J. A.**, Franco, D., Franco, J. A., & Norman, T. J. (April 2016). *Student Satisfaction in International College Students*. Presentation at the Western Decision Sciences Institute, Las Vegas, Nevada.
- Pedroza, J. A.**, Franco, J. A., Franco, D. & Norman, T. J. (April 2016). *Google Glass: The Influence of Recording Interviews on Prefrontal Cortex Activation*. Presentation at the Western Decision Sciences Institute, Las Vegas, Nevada.

Local Conferences

*denotes mentored undergraduate students

- Pedroza, J. A.** & Strang A. (March 2026). *Assessing Statistics Understanding: Early Detection of Learning Gaps using Diagnostic Classification Models*. Poster presentation at Berkeley School of Education Research Day, Berkeley, California.
- Pedroza, J. A.**, Yan, W., & Wilkerson, M. H. (March 2026). *Using Computational Notebooks as Teaching Tools: The Show Your Work Mapping Notebook*. Poster presentation at Berkeley School of Education Research Day, Berkeley, California.
- Lindsey, M.*, Smith, T.M., & **Pedroza, J. A.** (May 2018). *Latinx Perceptions of Their Environment: The Examination of Neighborhood Walkability by Region in a National Latinx Sample*. Poster presentation at Undergraduate Research Symposium, Eugene, Oregon.
- Bender, C.*, Smith, T.M., & **Pedroza, J. A.** (May 2018). *Examining Risk and Protective Factors in the Relationship Between Discrimination Stress and Body Mass Index (BMI) in a Sample of Latinx Adults*. Poster presentation at Undergraduate Research Symposium, Eugene, Oregon.
- Pedroza, J. A.** & Smith, T. M. (May 2018). *The Examination of Smartphone Use as a Moderator on the Association between Acculturation and Sedentary Behaviors*. Poster presentation at Graduate Research Forum, Eugene, Oregon.
- Smith, T. M., Vargas, K., & **Pedroza, J. A.** (February 2018). *Your Health Matters! Understanding Health Inequities in the Latinx Community*. Invited Presentation at Raza Unida Youth Conference, Eugene, Oregon.
- Pedroza, J. A.**, Carrier, L.M., & Rosen, L. D. (February 2017). *The Effects of Media and Technology Use on Psychological Well-Being Independent of Health Habits*. Presentation at Student Research Day, Carson, California.
- Pedroza, J. A.** & Rosen, L. D. (February 2017). *Pokémon GO and Meet People. Examination of Technology's Effect on Physical Activity and Social Connectedness*. Presentation at Student Research Day, Carson, California.
- Pedroza, J. A.** & Rosen, L. D. (February 2016). *Technology and Mental Well-being: A Literature Review Examining Media Use and Health Factors' Effects on Mental Health*. Poster presentation at Student Research Day, Carson, California.
- Pedroza, J. A.** & Morales, A. (March 2014). *Latinos Living with Diabetes: A Content Analysis of Interventions for Self-Management*. Poster presentation at Student Research Conference, Pomona, California.

Teaching & Mentoring Experience

Lecturer (Fall 2026)

INCLUDE COURSE HERE

UC Berkeley

Lecturer (Fall 2026)

INCLUDE COURSE HERE

UC Berkeley

Mentor (Spring 2026)

Latinx AI Fellowship

UC Berkeley

- Shared personal academic trajectories with mentees
- Discussed how my culture influences my research
- Learned about mentees' research discuss the benefits and drawbacks of pursuing graduate degrees

Invited Panelist (Winter 2025)

PREV 607: Seminar

University of Oregon

Topic: Professional Development
Instructor: Ashley Linden-Carmichael PhD

Lecturer (Spring 2022)
PSY 4433/A: Experimental Psychology & Activity
California State Polytechnic University, Pomona

Lecturer (Spring 2022)
PSY 3307/A: Statistics for Psychology & Activity
California State Polytechnic University, Pomona

Lecturer (Fall 2021)
PSY 3307/A: Statistics for Psychology (2 sections) & Activity
California State Polytechnic University, Pomona

Invited Panelist (Winter 2021)
FHS 492: Contemporary Issues in Public Health, Family and Human Services
University of Oregon
Topic: Community-based COVID-19 Prevention & Control Research
Instructor: Elizabeth L Budd MPH, PhD

Invited Panelist (Fall 2020)
PREV 633: Contemporary Issues in Public Health, Prevention Science
University of Oregon
Topic: Community-based COVID-19 Prevention & Control Research
Instructor: Elizabeth L Budd MPH, PhD

Invited Guest Lecturer (Winter 2020)
FHS 420: Research in Human Services, Family and Human Services
University of Oregon
Topic: Experimental Designs
Instructor: Justin Caouette PhD

Invited Guest Lecturer (Fall 2019)
FHS 328: Human Development in the Family Context, Family and Human Services
University of Oregon
Topic: Examination of Inequities of Immigrant Families in the United States
Instructor: Bertranna Muruthi PhD

Invited Guest Lecturer (Fall 2019)
FHS 328: Human Development in the Family Context, Family and Human Services
University of Oregon
Topic: Transition between Childhood and Adolescence: Middle Childhood
Instructor: Bertranna Muruthi PhD

Invited Guest Lecturer (Fall 2018)
FHS 215: Exploring Family and Human Services, Family and Human Services
University of Oregon
Topic: Working with Low Income Rural Populations
Instructor: Kavitha Rao MEd, MA

Invited Guest Lecturer (Winter 2018)
FHS 420: Research Methods, Family and Human Services
University of Oregon

Topic: Experiences Using fNIRS Neuroimaging Techniques

Instructor: Emily Tanner-Smith PhD

Teaching Assistant (Spring 2017)

UNV 395: Special Topics, McNair Scholars Program

California State University, Dominguez Hills

Instructor: Michelle Martinez EdD

- Gave guest lectures
- Graded Assignments
- Held Office Hours

Teaching Assistant (Spring 2016)

PSY 415 & 416: Advanced Research Methods in Cognitive Psychology, Department of Psychology

California State University, Dominguez Hills

Instructor: Alex Lim MA

- Gave guest lectures
- Graded Assignments
- Held Office Hours

Teaching Assistant (Fall 2015)

PSY 235: Introduction to Research Methods, Department of Psychology

California State University, Dominguez Hills

Instructor: Alex Lim MA

- Gave guest lectures
- Graded Assignments
- Held Office Hours

Teaching Assistant (Fall 2014)

PSY 455: Human Sexual Behavior: Relationships, Department of Psychology

California State Polytechnic University, Pomona

Instructor: Alejandro Morales PhD

- Gave guest lectures
- Held Office Hours

Relevant Work Experience

Data Science Education Postdoctoral Researcher (2025 - Present)

University of California, Berkeley

Supervisor: Michelle H Wilkerson PhD

- Evaluated [D-Lab](#) workshops to improve attendance and instructor preparedness
- Developed a foundational statistics workshop for data science skills

Data Science Mentor (2022 – Present)

Posit Academy - Posit

Supervisor: Kristin Bott

- Lead collaborative and presentation sessions for R and Python cohorts
- Mentor learners on visualizations, data manipulation, database management, data analysis, dashboards, and report creation
- Support students with troubleshooting R and Python code
- Propose changes for curriculum changes based on learners' needs

Data Scientist (2022 - 2024)

Accessible Teaching, Learning, & Assessment Systems - University of Kansas

Supervisors: W Jake Thompson PhD & Jennifer Kobrin EdD

- Took the lead as the co-chair of the Diversity, Equity, Inclusivity, and Belonging Committee
- Created reports for collaborating institutions
- Conducted ad-hoc analyses for research projects
- Constructed machine learning model that predicted the use of a text-to-speech function for students with significant cognitive disabilities
- Developed a Bayesian Network to measure student mastery of Dynamic Learning Maps (DLM) assessments
- Refined post-processing methods for optimal classification threshold selection
- Developed presentation and technical report templates to be presented to stakeholders
- Created a dashboard for state stakeholders to identify school districts struggling to implement DLM assessments
- Improved response rate to teachers' DLM questions using natural language processes

Lecturer in Psychology (2021 – 2022)

California State Polytechnic University, Pomona

Supervisor: Erika DeJonghe PhD

- Taught multiple sections of Statistics and Applied Experimental Design
- Instructed students how to calculate statistics by hand and using programming languages (e.g., SPSS and R)
- Trained students to conduct literature reviews, develop hypotheses, design experiments, conduct statistical analyses, and write academic reports
- Taught students t-tests, chi-square tests, as well as between-, within-design ANOVAs, linear and generalized linear regressions

Diversity and Inclusion Graduate Employee (2020-2021)

Division of Graduate Studies - University of Oregon

Supervisor: Padma Akkaraju PhD

- Created advisory groups to meet with departments to improve inclusivity for the Division of Graduate Studies
- Cleaned data for departments to choose candidates for Promising Scholar awards
- Organized data from McNair Scholars programs to match with graduate programs at the University of Oregon
- Developed a dashboard that showed increasing graduate student staffing levels resulted in an increase in undergraduate credits
- Held office hours for students with departmental issues
- Hosted professional development sessions with graduate students from various disciplines

Team Lead & Contact Tracer (2020)

Student Corps to Combat Coronavirus – University of Oregon

Supervisors: Angela Long MPH & Jeffrey Measelle PhD

- Interviewed potential positive cases of COVID-19
- Supervised several contact tracers
- Provided resources for contacts to get necessities during quarantine
- Worked alongside the local public health department to track cases and contacts

Graduate Teaching Assistant (2019-2020)

Family and Human Services – University of Oregon

Supervisor: Ellen McWhirter PhD

- Gave guest lectures
- Graded students' assignments
- Held office hours to assist students with assignments

Graduate Research Assistant (2017-2019)

The Culture and Health Promotion Laboratory - University of Oregon

Supervisors: Tasia M Smith PhD, Nichole R Kelly PhD, & Elizabeth L Budd PhD, MPH

- Collaborated on National Institute of Health grants
- Held training sessions for lab members on survey design, data analysis, and report writing
- Conducted a needs assessment and analyses for food insecurity in rural Oregon communities
- Conducted statistical analyses for several projects
- Presented project findings at academic conferences
- Supervised multiple research assistants in recruitment, data collection, and data cleaning for qualitative and quantitative projects
- Mentored research assistants' projects which resulted in conference presentations and an undergraduate thesis

Research Assistant (2017)

McNair Scholars Program – California State University, Dominguez Hills

Supervisor: Michelle Martinez EdD

- Created presentations for graduate school preparation
- Taught students how to create personal statements, diversity, statements, and CVs
- Provided edits on graduate school materials
- Assisted scholars with literature review, hypothesis formulation, methodology, analyses, and the writing process

Research Assistant (2016)

Book Title: From Smartphones to Social Media: How Technology Affects our Brains and Behavior

Supervisor: L Mark Carrier PhD

- Gathered literature on technology use areas
- Assisted in discussions about direction of chapters

Presentation Awards

- Runner up Best Student Oral Presentation Award (2019) Neighborhood Walkability is Associated with Physical Activity in Latinx Adults, Particularly Those with High Acculturation – American Public Health Association Conference, Physical Activity Section
- 1st Place Oral Presentation (2017) The Effects of Media and Technology Use on Psychological Well-Being Independent of Health Habits – California State University, Dominguez Hills Student Research Day Conference
- 2nd Place Oral Presentation (2017) Pokémon GO and Meet People. Examination of Technology's effect on Physical Activity and Social Connectedness – California State University, Dominguez Hills Student Research Day Conference
- Winning Paper and Poster Presentation (2016) Investigation of the Neural Correlates of Sex and Proficiency Level in Language Brokers: A Pilot Study Using Functional Near-Infrared (fNIR) Spectroscopy – South Bay Economic Forecast Conference
- 1st Place Oral Presentation (2016) Examination of Executive Functioning Behaviors: A Comparison between Light and Heavy Technology Users – California State University, Dominguez Hills Student Research Day Conference
- 1st Place Oral Presentation (2016) A Comparison in Prefrontal Cortex Activity between Light and Heavy Technology Users – California State University, Dominguez Hills Student Research Day Conference

Honors & Awards

- California State University Chancellor's Doctoral Incentive Program (2020-2021)
- General University Scholarship - \$2,700 (Fall 2020)
- Society of Prevention Research ECPN Travel Award (Spring 2019)
- General University Scholarship - \$2,700 (Fall 2018)
- APA Division 45 Conference Travel Award (Summer 2018)
- American Psychological Association's Travel Award (Spring 2018)

- Graduate Research Advancement & Development Grant (Spring 2017)
- Promising Scholar Award (Fall 2017)
- Graduate Equity Fellowship - \$5,000 (Summer 2016)
- Graduate Research Advancement & Development Grant (Spring 2016)

Package Development Contributions

- [Thresholdr](#)

Open-Source Projects

- [Dashboard on Dental Visits and Costs Between Males and Females](#)
- [Web Application for Building a Discrete Bayesian Network \(Docker Image\)](#)
- [Percentile Ranking for Psychological Assessments](#)
- [Dashboard on Exit Survey Data From Graduate Students at the University of Oregon \(Docker Image\)](#)
- [Dashboard of the Association Between Graduate Student Teaching and Undergraduate Credit Hours](#)

Training & Service

- International Society of the Learning Sciences Reviewer (2026)
- American Public Health Association Physical Activity Section Abstract Reviewer (2020)
- APA Advanced Training Institute – Research Methods with Diverse and Ethnic Group (2017)